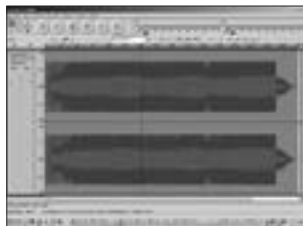


value you selected. Or, you can make a list of songs that are noticeably louder or softer than the rest of your collection, and then use Audacity to make the songs softer or louder, as the case may be.



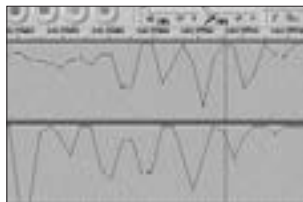
Here's the waveform for the normalised track

5.7 Amplifying And Clipping

As we mentioned above, when a track is too loud or too soft in comparison to the others in your collection, you need to increase or decrease the volume whenever it is played. To avoid this, you can use Audacity's Amplify effect. Though amplification is generally synonymous with *increasing* the loudness of a song, in Audacity, you can use this effect even to make a song softer than it currently is.

Open a track, use [Ctrl] + [A] to select all then click on Effect > Amplify..., then move the sliders or fill in the value you desire. You have two values to look at here: Amplification (dB), and New Peak Amplitude (dB). Amplification is the amount in dB that you want to increase or decrease the sound by, while New Peak Amplitude determines how loud the loudest sound in the song will be. If a song is too loud, use negative values in the options to make it softer.

Another important thing to remember when using the Amplify effect is the *clipping* we've been talking about. The audio amplifiers in your soundcard and speaker system do have a maximum output limit, and once this limit is reached, your speakers will be driven at their maximum output until the sound level falls below the limit again. To you, the lis-



A waveform suffering the woes of clipping